

HVAC App Upgrade Project

Call Summary & Requirements

Context

Chandler Giesbrecht (HVAC company owner) discusses app upgrade requirements with a developer. They currently have a basic app with a quote builder and process builder, but want to expand it into a comprehensive, all-in-one business tool.

Immediate Priority Features (Phase 1)

1. Process & System Builder ■ TOP PRIORITY

- AI-assisted process documentation with voice-to-text (similar to ChatGPT's microphone feature)
- Step-by-step format with 'why' explanations
- Ability to view, create, and store company processes/checklists
- Export capability for printing physical handbook
- Wiki-style organization with categories
- Training tool for technicians to reference in real-time

2. Price Book Integration ■ HIGH PRIORITY

- View-only PDF display of install pricing (from Proposal Pro software)
- Easy navigation for customer presentations
- Screenshot capability for texting quotes to clients
- Separate from service pricing (which lives in Field Edge)
- Used for 'window shopping' before formal quotes

Secondary Features (Phase 2)

3. Uniform Ordering System

- Form-based interface for new technician onboarding
- Size selection for shirts, pants, etc.
- Direct email integration to uniform provider
- One-click order submission

4. Inventory Management

- Integration with existing spreadsheet
- Search functionality for stock checking
- Real-time inventory visibility for technicians

5. Vehicle Tracking Integration

- Embed Bouncie tracking software dashboard
- Possible API integration to avoid logins
- May use iframe/redirect approach
- Consolidated view within app

6. Load Analysis Tool

- Previously built calculator for HVAC system sizing
- Input data to calculate tonnage requirements
- Sales support tool

Long-Term Vision (Phase 3)

The \$50K Dream: Custom Dispatch/CRM System

- Built-in WhatsApp integration
- Custom dispatch software replacing Field Edge
- AI knowledge base trained on company data
- Accumulated technical knowledge (50+ years of experience)
- Voice/phone system integration
- Searchable database of processes, videos, and solutions
- Significant company value-add for potential sale

Philosophy

Reduce dependency on expensive subscription services (Service Titan, Field Edge) by building custom solutions using no-code/low-code platforms (Replit). Create a single app that consolidates 5-7 different tools technicians currently juggle.

Technical Considerations

Current Tech Stack:

- Replit for development
- Integration with: Field Edge, Company Cam, Proposal Pro, Trello
- OpenAI for AI features
- Hosting: Netlify (mentioned for web hosting)

Key Challenges:

- API key maintenance (Trello expires yearly)
- User authentication for embedded web apps
- Mobile responsiveness (iPhone vs Android differences noted)
- Balance between dummy-proofing and employee empowerment

Business Drivers

1. **Onboarding Simplification** - New sales hire and future technicians need streamlined training

2. **Centralization** - Eliminate app overload ('go to this app for this, that app for that')
3. **Cost Reduction** - Avoid expensive CRM subscriptions
4. **Company Value** - Build proprietary knowledge base that increases business worth
5. **Future-Proofing** - Leverage AI/no-code tools before competitors do

Next Steps Agreed Upon

1. Developer to prioritize Process Builder implementation
2. Chandler to provide credit card for API costs (OpenAI, hosting)
3. Price Book PDF to be shared for integration
4. Developer has flexibility to implement and bill as needed
5. Regular check-ins as features develop

Key Quote

"I'm really trying to get it to where there's one app for a lot of things... it's because that's one of the confusing things when I train new techs - you go to this app for this, and you go to this app for this... I'd like to make it easier for them to just open one app."

Project Status: Active development with clear priorities and long-term roadmap established.